

CURATORIAL PACKET



Harbor Voices: Mapping a Working Waterfront

Gallery handoff file with wall-text drafts, object labels, school group notes, and visitor services cautions.

Curator memo

The approved public title is woven through the wall-text draft. Older working titles - Harbor Machines, Dockside Futures, Waterfront Memory Lab - appear in collection notes but should not become the exhibition headline. Treat the packet as a mix of visitor language and back-of-house planning.

Label editor note

Prefer concrete visitor experiences over department process language.

Margin hold

Ticketing, gala, credit, and prototype-gallery details need visitor services approval.

Graphic implication

Lead with the exhibition title and three visitor experiences; keep opening hours and museum team as supporting copy.

Intro wall text draft

The graphic should invite families, local history visitors, and middle-school groups into a story about labor, maps, and memory along the harbor. The introduction should sound like gallery copy, not an event flyer.

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Object label cluster A

Dock tools, photographs, and logbook fragments are grouped so visitors can compare evidence rather than read a chronology. Labels should point to what visitors can observe: material wear, route marks, and workplace changes.

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Visitor thread 1

Listen to oral-history clips from dockworkers

Visitor thread 2

Trace trade routes on layered harbor maps

Visitor thread 3

Compare tools and photographs from working piers

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Audio station note

Oral-history clips from dockworkers are cleared for visitor-facing copy. Keep the phrasing short and active. Do not imply all interviews are available online or that the audio station is a VR installation.

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Map table note

Layered maps show trade routes and shoreline change over time. Avoid implying a live navigation or planning tool. The map table is an interpretive object, not a city planning service.

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Visitor services update

Opens September 12, 2026; Thursdays-Sundays, 11 AM-5 PM. School group inquiries open after August 28, 2026; ticket price and gala language are held by visitor services. Do not add a school-credit promise.

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Back-of-house comment

August 29, VR alcove, school credit, and Seabright Foundation gala are not approved for the public introduction graphic. August 29 opening; Seabright Foundation gala; ticket price; VR alcove; school credit Use these notes only to avoid resurrecting outdated copy.

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